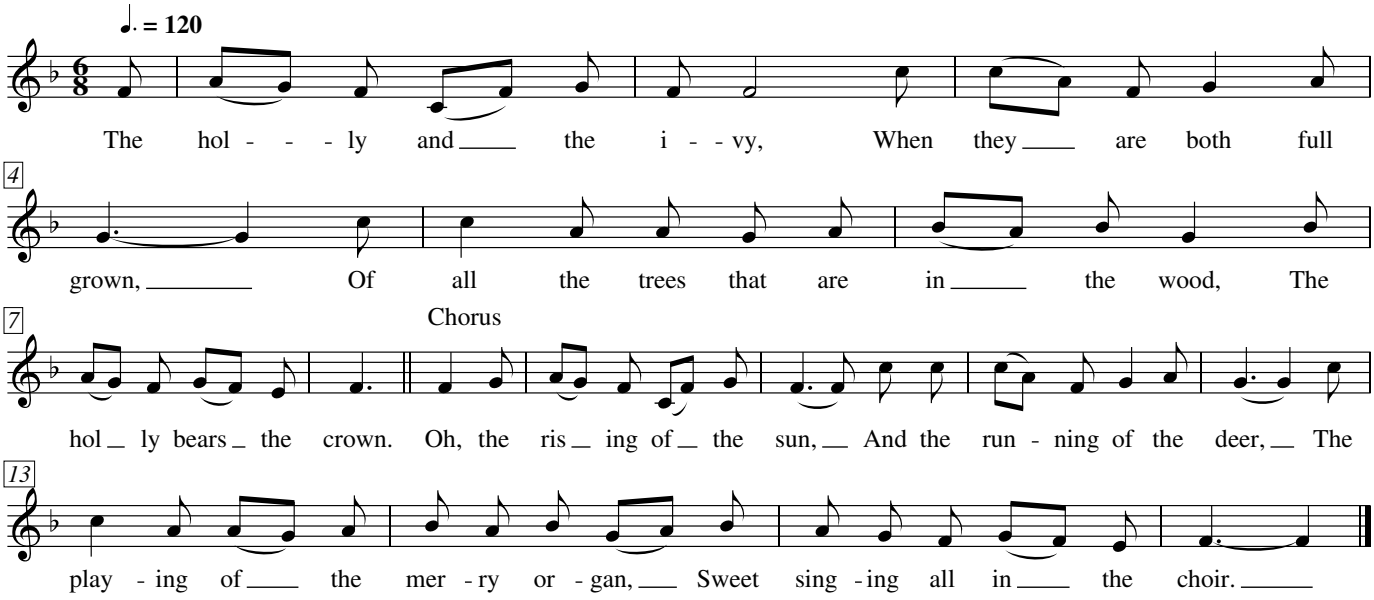
The Holly and the Ivy

originally collected by Maud Karpeles and Pat Shaw
new secular words by Rosie Hodgson

Drumming: 4 beat lead in; drumming throughout



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1. The holly and the ivy
   When they are both full grown
   Of all the trees that are in the wood
   The holly bears the crown

   Oh, the rising of the sun
   And the running of the deer
   The playing of the merry organ
   Sweet singing all in the choir

2. The holly bears a blossom
   As white as lays the snow
   And deep beneath the spring she sleeps
   While icy winds do blow

3. The holly bears a berry
   As red as any blood
   The beating heart of the merry green wood
   Shines through the frost and flood

4. The holly bears a prickle
   As sharp as any thorn
   The frost that holds the fields and folds
   Is vanquished by the dawn

5. The holly bears a bark
   As bitter as any gall
   Burn fear and blame with fire and flame
   As new year comes to call

   We usually don't sing the last verse

6. The holly and the ivy
   When they are both full grown
   Of all the trees that are in the wood
   The holly bears the crown